

BERRY PEREMBE

Head of Data & Analytics | Data Science, AI & Risk Governance

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Strategic Head of Data & Analytics with 10+ years of experience across financial services, retail and telecommunications, combining enterprise data strategy, advanced analytics, data science, AI enablement and risk governance. Proven record of building analytics capability, shaping governed cloud-data platforms, translating complex regulatory and commercial questions into auditable analytical solutions, and leading fraud, AML/KYC, customer and operational analytics. Trusted partner to executive, risk, compliance, product and technology stakeholders, with hands-on expertise in Snowflake, AWS, SQL, Python, Tableau and predictive modelling. Recognised for connecting data foundations, governance and responsible AI to measurable business outcomes, including improved decision support, operational control, customer insight and audit readiness.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Data & AI Strategy	Fraud, AML/KYC & Risk Analytics	Snowflake & Cloud Data Platforms
Data Governance & Stewardship	Advanced Analytics & Machine Learning	Analytics Operating Models
Responsible AI & Model Governance	Customer Segmentation & Churn	Tableau & Self-Service BI
Executive Stakeholder Leadership	Audit-Ready Evidence & Reporting	Portfolio Prioritisation & Delivery

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Data & Analytics Platforms	AWS (Athena, Redshift, S3), Snowflake, SQL Server, data lakes and cloud data warehouses
BI & Visualisation	Tableau, Power BI, executive dashboards, KPI frameworks and self-service analytics
Programming & Scripting	Advanced SQL, Python, R
Analytics Techniques	Machine learning, predictive modelling, segmentation, churn, anomaly/fraud analytics, text analytics, clustering, regression and factor analysis
Data Management	Data governance, data quality, data lineage, access controls, ETL/ELT, auditability and regulatory reporting
Other Tools	Alteryx Designer, SPSS, n8n automation, Jira and Microsoft 365

CAREER HISTORY

Head: Data & Analytics

Shoprite Financial Services | March 2025 – Present

- Own and execute the Financial Services data and analytics strategy, aligning data foundations, business intelligence, advanced analytics and AI priorities with executive objectives, product growth and regulatory obligations.
- Lead the analytics function and delivery portfolio, setting priorities, allocating scarce capacity, coaching analysts and data scientists, and defining the phased operating model and capability roadmap for BI, data engineering, data science and AI.

- Provide executive decision support by translating complex commercial, customer, operational, fraud and compliance questions into clear analytical approaches, governed metrics, dashboards, evidence packs and board-ready narratives.
- Direct fraud, financial-crime and risk analytics across blocked and frozen accounts, unauthorised outflows, account lifecycle events and behavioural typologies, coordinating transaction-level root-cause analysis with Risk, Compliance, Product and Technology stakeholders.
- Champion data governance and stewardship by promoting approved data-sharing processes, minimum-necessary access, data quality controls, traceability, reason codes, documented assumptions and audit-ready evidence for sensitive customer and transaction data.
- Shape the Financial Services cloud-data architecture and Project Nexus roadmap, advocating for secure data landing, scalable Snowflake analytical layers, resilient pipelines, reusable data products and governed self-service access.
- Sponsor advanced analytics and AI use cases including fraud detection, churn prediction, customer segmentation, propensity-led targeting, risk identification, LLM-enabled analytics and intelligent automation, with focus on explainability, control and measurable value.
- Oversee Tableau and analytics product delivery, including KPI design, reconciliation, release readiness and migration from manual or fragmented reporting towards automated, trusted and scalable decision-support solutions.
- Build cross-functional alignment across executive leadership, Risk, Legal and Compliance, Financial Services product teams, Data Platforms, IT and external partners; clarify ownership, dependencies, delivery risks and escalation paths.
- Develop investment cases and resource plans for the analytics function, linking capability requirements to regulatory confidence, fraud monitoring, data trust, commercial insight and future AI readiness.

Key Achievements:

- Led the Financial Services data transformation vision and developed the Project Nexus analytics-platform case, connecting centralised data integration, Snowflake, self-service BI, advanced analytics, AI and governance into a single strategic roadmap.
- Led an audit-focused investigation into blocked and frozen accounts, quantifying approximately R17.7 million in unauthorised post-block outflows and helping shape a prudent R20 million provision, transaction-level root-cause analysis and supporting audit narrative.
- Designed the Financial Services analytics strategy and future operating model across data foundation, reporting and BI, advanced analytics, fraud and compliance, machine learning, AI automation and capability growth.
- Strengthened governance of sensitive customer data by challenging uncontrolled internal sharing, reinforcing approved privacy and compliance processes, and advocating for documented access, traceability and stewardship controls.
- Drove analytics modernisation across Snowflake and Tableau workstreams, supporting automated reporting, reconciliation, near-real-time visibility and governed decision support for Money Market Account and wider Financial Services use cases.

Lead Analyst – Financial Services

Shoprite Group | September 2021 – March 2025

- Led delivery and execution of complex data solutions and advanced analytics products delivering measurable business value across Shoprite's Financial Services division.
- Oversaw portfolio of Advanced Analytics and Data Science projects, providing technical expertise across diverse business use cases.
- Worked with business stakeholders to identify requirements, model business scenarios, and prioritise analytics projects based on strategic impact.
- Developed, planned, and delegated data modelling projects, balancing business and technical trade-offs to ensure timely delivery.
- Communicated analytical findings to senior stakeholders using data visualisation techniques to tell compelling stories tied to enterprise goals.
- Evaluated emerging technologies and developed prototypes and proof of concepts for new analytical capabilities.
- Coached and mentored analysts and data scientists, fostering a high-performing team culture.

Key Achievements:

- Completed in-house Senior Leadership Development programme in Strategic management.
- Developed customer segmentation models and churn prediction solutions driving targeted business interventions.

Senior Decision Support Analyst

Capfin SA | January 2020 – August 2021

- Drove business efficiency in Payments, Collections, Finance, and Recoveries through data-driven analytics and decision support solutions.
- Designed and implemented decision support solutions from requirements gathering through to deployment in the data warehouse.
- Applied Data Science methodologies to develop predictive analytics solutions for automated decision-making.
- Enhanced stakeholder adoption of data, reports, and analytical tools for improved decision-making across business units.
- Collaborated with Data Science and IT teams to implement embedded automated decision solutions.

Key Achievements:

- Built a text analytics tool (Python/R) performing sentiment analysis, topic modelling, and classification on unstructured data (social media, emails, SMS, surveys), delivering rich customer insights.

Senior Analyst (Data Science)

Dashboard Intelligence Systems | February 2018 – December 2019

- Applied machine learning methods to solve complex problems in marketing research.
- Researched and evaluated data science tools for business decision-support applications.
- Delivered insights using various ML algorithms and text analytics techniques.

Senior Analyst

Dashboard Marketing Intelligence | March 2010 – January 2018

- Analysed market research data using advanced data mining techniques including clustering, regression, factor analysis, and outlier detection to develop actionable insights and recommendations.
- Led development and implementation of business requirements driven by analytical insights, coordinating system improvements for client experience and scalability.
- Built automated reporting systems and online dashboards using Tableau and other BI tools.
- Applied statistical and machine learning methods for predictive analytics across marketing intelligence use cases.

Key Achievements:

- Lead Analyst on the MTN Market Performance Report (MPR) Brand and Customer Experience Tracker and B2B research across the MTN Group for 6 years.
- Pioneered introduction of machine learning techniques to the company's analytics portfolio.

EDUCATION

Post Graduate Diploma: Computer and Media Studies

Specialisation in Data Analytics and Business Intelligence – *cum laude*

University of the Western Cape | 2017 – 2018

BSc Honors Degree: Applied Mathematics

Upper Second-Class Division

National University of Science and Technology (NUST), Zimbabwe | 2004 – 2008